

ADOLF HITLER MISUSING THE OLYMPIC GAMES

In 1931, the IOC selected the German capital city of Berlin as the host of the 1936 Summer Games. After Adolf Hitler came to power in 1933, the Olympics started aligning with the dictator's dangerous Nazi politics. A number of prominent politicians and organisations called for a boycott of the Games, while other campaigners called for it to be relocated. Despite the pushback, the event was conducted and still remains a blot on the Olympic landscape.

Hitler considered the Berlin event as 'his' Olympics and misused it to spread his Nazi propaganda and Post-War German glorification.



1936



1956

BLOOD IN THE WATER

The Soviet Union's invasion of Hungary had raised intense tension leading up to the 1956 Summer Olympics in Melbourne. Several countries like Spain, the Netherlands and Switzerland boycotted the event following the IOC's decision to allow Soviet athletes to participate.

The Soviet-Hungarian tension boiled over when the two men's water polo teams met for the semifinal. Several players from both teams started getting increasingly violent as the game progressed resulting in absolute mayhem.

The crowd was prevented from rioting only because the police intervened in time. Hungary's Ervin Zador was punched in the eye by Soviet Union's Valentin Prokopov. This infamous match came to be known as the 'Blood in the Water'.

1968

TLATELOLCO MASSACRE

In an attempt to make use of the media attention and coverage leading up to the Olympics, students took to the

streets of Mexico to protest against the atrocities of their authoritarian government. Days ahead of the inauguration, they marched on the streets of Tlatelolco in Mexico City demanding an end of police repression and the release of political prisoners.

The government repressed the protest using military might, firing at thousands of students resulting in several deaths.